

Ask Cinderhaven — Which channel actually makes money?

baseline scenario — figures reconcile to Channel Profitability Analysis

Which channel actually makes money?

Distributor, Retailer are contribution-margin negative — \$420,235,476 drag on the business after COGS, deductions, and trade spend. Every dollar of revenue from these channels is destroying value. DTC is the one making money: \$442,197 contribution margin.

2 channel(s) negative

Key numbers

DTC	Best channel \$442,197 contribution margin
Retailer	Weakest channel \$-272,065,680
\$-419,793,279	Total contribution margin

How this verdict was reached

Source: mart_channel_contribution — the only table where retailer, distributor, and DTC pipelines are reconciled on a common cost basis. Contribution margin = net_revenue — COGS — trade_spend. Any negative contribution_margin is an automatic verdict.

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Channel Profitability Analysis: </channel-profitability>

Built by Lailara LLC — data hygiene and analytics consulting for specialty food brands scaling into national retail.
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